

calculated by summing the values of data series and dividing the sum by the number of values in the series.

Chapter 5, "Radar Charts Or Watch Out for That Zen Speed Trap" (I've got to give him credit for amusing chapter titles!), exposes two other weaknesses of concern. Page 84 shows a radar chart with five axes, each measuring a criterion for evaluating new car models. The chart includes an annotation labeling a measurement as 7.5 when the chart itself reads 7.0. Such sloppiness is especially disconcerting in a book advocating truth in graphing.

The other weakness is more subtle. Three pages later, Jones claims that "the quest for symmetry is the beauty of the radar chart." And "symmetrical plots are 'good,' asymmetrical 'bad.'" These claims do not appear to be based on anything more than "I've heard these radar charts are particularly popular in Japan." The Japanese appreciation for symmetry is not necessarily an adequate reason for Jones' warning that "the radar chart imposes a bias on the interpretation of the data. . . ." Unsubstantiated statements and warnings abound in this book, so the reader must spend a great deal of time sorting reasonable suggestions from unfounded opinions.

In spite of the above shortcomings, Jones makes the book worthwhile with the very informative chapter "Color, Its Uses and Abuses." His experience as the author of a series of articles for *Computer Graphics World* as well as books on creating presentations with Harvard Graphics and Freelance Graphics shines through in discussions ranging

from mixing colors on a computer to the psychology of color's effect on audience emotions. Neither Kosslyn nor Cleveland approaches this subject in as much depth, making *How to Lie with Charts* a valuable, though limited, resource.

The breadth and step-by-step guidance of *Elements of Graph Design*, the depth and real-world examples of *The Elements of Graphing Data*, and Jones' writing style and chapter on color in *How to Lie with Charts* combine to form a comprehensive set of guidelines for anyone designing graphs to communicate information or analyze data.

Dale E. Schreiner
Publishing Manager
Griggs-Anderson Research
Portland, OR

LETTER PERFECT: A GUIDE TO PRACTICAL PROOFREADING. Peggy Smith. Alexandria, VA: EEI, 1995. 230 pages, including appendixes and index. \$24.95 (softcover).

According to Peggy Smith, proofreading involves two primary tasks: (1) catching errors and problems and (2) marking them so whoever makes the corrections will understand what to do. Convinced that most manuscript errors can be traced to problems concerning the proper use of copyediting symbols, she devised a simplified system of



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